

HOTEL MANAGEMENT SaaS

Comprehensive Feature Guide

A Complete Blueprint for Building a Competitive Hotel PMS

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CORE PMS FEATURES (Must-Have)

1. Reservation Management

Front desk operations:

- Real-time room availability dashboard
- Check-in / Check-out processing
- Walk-in guest registration
- Group reservations and block bookings
- Waitlist management
- Reservation modifications and cancellations
- Split reservations
- Room moves and swaps

Booking sources tracking:

- Direct bookings
- OTA bookings (with commission tracking)
- Walk-ins
- Corporate bookings
- Travel agent bookings

Guest profile management:

- Guest history and preferences
- VIP/special guest tagging
- Blacklist management
- Guest documents storage (ID, passport copies)
- Communication history
- Allergy and special requirement notes

2. Room & Inventory Management

Room operations:

- Room type configuration (Single, Double, Suite, etc.)
- Room status tracking (Vacant, Occupied, Dirty, Clean, Out of Order)
- Room blocking for maintenance
- Room assignment rules (auto-assign, manual)
- Connecting/adjoining room management
- Bed configuration tracking

Rate management:

- Multiple rate plans (BAR, Corporate, Government, Package rates)
- Seasonal pricing
- Dynamic pricing engine
- Weekend vs. weekday rates
- Length-of-stay discounts
- Early bird/advance purchase rates
- Last-minute rates
- Minimum/maximum stay restrictions
- Close-to-arrival/departure restrictions

Inventory controls:

- Overbooking controls
- Stop-sell functionality
- Allocation by channel
- Room type upgrades and downgrades

3. Channel Manager Integration

OTA connectivity:

- Two-way sync with Booking.com, Expedia, Agoda, etc.
- Real-time rate and availability updates
- Automatic reservation import
- Rate parity management
- Commission tracking by channel
- Channel performance analytics

Channel management features:

- Multi-channel dashboard
- Bulk rate updates
- Restriction management across channels
- Mapping room types across channels
- Promotion distribution

4. Booking Engine (Direct Bookings)

Guest-facing features:

- Responsive, mobile-friendly design
- Real-time availability calendar
- Room type comparison
- Photo galleries
- Amenities display
- Rate plan selection
- Add-ons (breakfast, parking, early check-in)
- Multi-language support
- Multi-currency support
- Promo code application

Technical features:

- Embeddable widget for hotel website
- Standalone booking page
- White-label capabilities
- Secure payment processing
- Instant confirmation emails
- Google Hotel Ads integration
- Meta search integration
- Abandoned booking recovery

5. Housekeeping Management

Room status updates:

- Real-time room status changes
- Housekeeping assignment
- Mobile app for housekeeping staff
- Task prioritization
- Cleaning checklists
- Lost & found tracking
- Maintenance request creation
- Cleaning time tracking
- Inspection workflow

Inventory management:

- Linen tracking
- Amenity inventory
- Consumables management
- Reorder alerts

6. Front Desk Operations

Guest services:

- Night audit automation
- Folio management
- Split billing
- City ledger accounts
- Credit limit management
- Payment posting
- Deposit handling
- Advance deposits
- No-show management
- Express check-out

Front desk tools:

- Guest messaging
- Wake-up call scheduling
- Luggage tracking
- Mail/package tracking
- Key card encoding integration
- Door lock system integration

FINANCIAL MANAGEMENT (Must-Have)

7. Billing & Invoicing

- Multiple folio management per reservation
- Split bills by guest or item
- Master folio for groups
- Company/travel agent billing
- Tax configuration (multiple tax rates, inclusive/exclusive)
- Service charge automation
- Discount application and tracking
- Deposit and prepayment handling
- Credit card authorization and capture
- Refund processing

8. Payment Processing

Payment gateways:

- Stripe, PayPal, Authorize.net integration
- Local payment gateway support
- PCI compliance
- Tokenization for card-on-file
- 3D Secure support
- Virtual terminal for manual entry

Payment methods:

- Credit/debit cards
- Cash
- Bank transfer
- Mobile wallets
- Split payments
- Corporate accounts
- Vouchers/credits

9. Accounting & Reporting

Financial reports:

- Daily revenue report
- Night audit report
- Manager's flash report
- Revenue by room type
- Revenue by rate plan
- Revenue by booking source
- Tax collection reports
- Cashier shift reports
- Accounts receivable aging
- City ledger report

Operational reports:

- Occupancy reports
- ADR (Average Daily Rate)
- RevPAR (Revenue Per Available Room)
- Forecast reports
- Arrivals/departures list
- In-house guest list
- No-show reports
- Cancellation reports
- Source of business analysis
- Market segment analysis

Accounting integration:

- QuickBooks integration
- Xero integration
- Manual journal entry export
- Chart of accounts mapping
- Automated posting rules

GUEST EXPERIENCE FEATURES (High Priority)

10. Guest Communication

- Pre-arrival emails (confirmation, upsell)
- Check-in reminder
- Post-stay thank you
- Review request automation
- SMS notifications
- In-stay messaging
- WhatsApp integration
- Guest app/portal
- Digital check-in/check-out
- Online concierge
- Email templates and customization

11. Guest Engagement

- Loyalty program management
- Points earning and redemption
- Member rates
- Guest preferences tracking
- Special occasion recognition
- Upsell and cross-sell automation
- Package creation
- Experience bookings
- Guest surveys and feedback collection

12. Online Check-in/Check-out

- Mobile check-in
- ID verification
- Signature capture
- Payment collection
- Room selection
- Upgrade offers
- Express checkout
- Digital receipts
- Mobile key integration (optional)

REVENUE MANAGEMENT (Important)

13. Dynamic Pricing

- Demand-based pricing algorithms
- Competitor rate shopping
- Price recommendations
- Automated rate adjustments
- Pickup tracking
- Forecast accuracy
- Optimization by segment
- Restriction recommendations

14. Yield Management

- Occupancy forecasting
- Revenue forecasting
- Rate strategy recommendations
- Pickup pace analysis
- Historical performance comparison
- Events calendar integration
- Market demand indicators

BACK OFFICE & ADMIN (Must-Have)

15. User Management

Role-based access control (RBAC):

- Front desk agent
- Manager
- Housekeeping
- Accounting
- Owner (view-only)
- Custom roles
- Multi-property access control
- Audit logs
- User activity tracking
- Password policies
- Two-factor authentication
- SSO integration (enterprise)

16. Property Configuration

- Multiple property management
- Property details and policies
- Cancellation policies
- Tax settings
- Currency settings
- Language settings
- Brand customization
- Email/invoice branding
- Terms and conditions

17. Staff Management

- Employee records
- Shift scheduling
- Time tracking (optional)
- Task assignment
- Department management
- Performance tracking

ADDITIONAL MODULES (Advanced)

18. Point of Sale (POS)

- Restaurant billing
- Bar billing
- Spa services
- Room service
- Minibar charges
- Post charges to room
- Inventory tracking for F&B;
- Menu management
- Table management
- Order taking (mobile)
- Kitchen display system integration

19. Maintenance Management

- Work order creation
- Priority assignment
- Technician assignment
- Asset tracking
- Preventive maintenance scheduling
- Maintenance history
- Vendor management
- Spare parts inventory

20. Events & Banquets

- Function space management
- Event booking calendar
- Catering packages
- Equipment rental
- Event contracts
- BEO (Banquet Event Orders)
- Floor plans
- Menu planning
- Staff assignment

21. Customer Relationship Management (CRM)

- Lead tracking
- Sales pipeline
- Email campaigns
- Marketing automation
- Segment creation

- Campaign performance tracking
- Guest lifetime value

INTEGRATIONS & API (Critical for SaaS)

22. Third-Party Integrations

Essential integrations:

- Channel managers (Siteminder, Channel Manager, etc.)
- OTAs (Booking.com, Expedia API)
- Payment gateways (Stripe, PayPal, etc.)
- Accounting software (QuickBooks, Xero)
- Email services (SendGrid, Mailgun)
- SMS providers (Twilio)
- Google Analytics
- Review platforms (TripAdvisor, Google Reviews)

Advanced integrations:

- Revenue management systems (IDeaS, Duetto)
- Smart locks (Salto, Assa Abloy)
- Key card systems
- Guest experience platforms
- Reputation management tools
- Booking.com Connectivity APIs
- GDS connections (for larger hotels)
- Event management systems

23. Open API

- RESTful API
- Webhook support
- Developer documentation
- API key management
- Rate limiting
- Sandbox environment
- API usage analytics

ANALYTICS & BUSINESS INTELLIGENCE (High Value)

24. Dashboard & KPIs

- Real-time occupancy
- Revenue today vs. forecast
- ADR trends
- RevPAR trends
- Booking pace
- Cancellation rate
- Average length of stay
- Top booking sources
- Top guest countries
- Room type performance
- Customizable widgets

25. Advanced Analytics

- Predictive occupancy
- Revenue forecasting
- Market segment analysis
- Guest behavior analytics
- Booking window analysis
- Denials and regrets tracking
- Competitive set benchmarking
- Custom report builder
- Scheduled report delivery
- Export to Excel/PDF

MOBILE CAPABILITIES (Important)

26. Mobile Apps

Staff app:

- Check-in/check-out on mobile
- Housekeeping status updates
- Guest messaging
- Task management
- Offline mode support

Guest app (optional but valuable):

- Mobile check-in
- Digital room key
- Service requests
- In-app messaging
- Bill review
- Mobile checkout

COMPLIANCE & SECURITY (Critical)

27. Data Security

- PCI DSS compliance
- GDPR compliance tools
- Data encryption (at rest and in transit)
- Regular security audits
- Backup and disaster recovery
- Data retention policies
- Right to erasure (GDPR)
- Data export functionality

28. Legal & Regulatory

- Police reporting (varies by country)
- Tourist tax collection
- Government registration forms
- Terms of service
- Privacy policy
- Cookie consent
- Accessibility (WCAG compliance)

PLATFORM FEATURES (SaaS Essentials)

29. Multi-Property Management

- Property groups/chains
- Centralized dashboard for multiple properties
- Inter-property transfers
- Consolidated reporting
- Central reservation system (CRS)
- Property-level vs. chain-level settings
- Cross-property promotions

30. Onboarding & Support

- Property setup wizard
- Data migration tools
- Training materials
- Video tutorials
- Knowledge base
- Live chat support
- Email/ticket support
- Phone support
- Dedicated account manager (enterprise)
- Community forum

31. Subscription & Billing

- Multiple pricing tiers
- Per-property pricing
- Per-room pricing
- Free trial period
- Self-service signup
- Upgrade/downgrade flows
- Billing portal
- Invoice generation
- Payment method management
- Usage-based billing (advanced)

DIFFERENTIATION OPPORTUNITIES (Where You Can Win)

Smart Features to Stand Out:

1. AI-Powered Features:

- Smart pricing recommendations
- Automated guest segmentation
- Predictive maintenance alerts
- Chatbot for guest inquiries
- Review sentiment analysis
- Anomaly detection (fraud, unusual bookings)

2. Automation:

- Automated upselling (room upgrades, early check-in)
- Smart task assignment
- Auto-generated email sequences
- Automated review responses
- Auto-posting to social media

3. Modern UX/UI:

- Intuitive, minimal learning curve
- Dark mode
- Keyboard shortcuts
- Drag-and-drop scheduling
- Real-time collaboration
- Mobile-first design

4. Performance:

- Sub-second load times
- 99.9% uptime SLA
- Real-time synchronization
- Offline capabilities

5. Unique Features:

- Environmental impact tracking (sustainability)
- Carbon footprint calculator
- Staff wellness tracking
- Guest sentiment tracking
- Integrated marketplace (for purchasing supplies)
- Contactless everything (QR codes for menus, check-in, etc.)

MVP RECOMMENDATION (Start Here)

For your Minimum Viable Product (MVP), focus on these core modules:

Phase 1 (MVP) - 3-6 months:

- ✓ Reservation management (basic)
- ✓ Room inventory management
- ✓ Rate management (basic)
- ✓ Booking engine (direct bookings)
- ✓ Check-in/check-out
- ✓ Billing & invoicing
- ✓ Payment processing (1-2 gateways)
- ✓ Basic reports (occupancy, revenue)
- ✓ User management & roles
- ✓ Guest profiles

Phase 2 - 6-12 months:

- ✓ Channel manager integration (top 3-5 OTAs)
- ✓ Housekeeping management
- ✓ Advanced reporting & analytics
- ✓ Guest communication automation
- ✓ Mobile app for staff
- ✓ Online check-in/check-out

Phase 3 - 12-18 months:

- ✓ POS integration
- ✓ Dynamic pricing
- ✓ CRM features
- ✓ Multi-property management
- ✓ API marketplace
- ✓ Advanced integrations

PRICING STRATEGY INSIGHTS

Based on competitor analysis:

Property Size	Monthly Price Range
Small (1-10 rooms)	\$50 - \$150/month
Mid-size (11-50 rooms)	\$150 - \$500/month
Large (51-200 rooms)	\$500 - \$2,000/month
Enterprise (200+ rooms)	Custom pricing

Common Pricing Models:

- Per property flat fee
- Per room/unit (e.g., \$3-10 per room/month)
- Tiered features (Basic, Professional, Enterprise)
- Commission-free direct bookings as a selling point

CONCLUSION

This comprehensive guide outlines the essential features needed to build a competitive Hotel Management SaaS platform. Success in this market requires focusing on three key areas: 1. **Core PMS Excellence:** Your reservation, inventory, and billing systems must be rock-solid and intuitive. 2. **Integration Ecosystem:** Seamless connections with OTAs, payment gateways, and third-party services are critical. 3. **Differentiation:** AI-powered features, superior UX/UI, and unique capabilities will set you apart from established competitors. Start with a focused MVP covering the essential property management features, then expand based on customer feedback and market demand. The hotel technology market is competitive but there's always room for innovation, especially for platforms that combine modern technology with deep understanding of hotel operations. **Key Success Factors:** • Focus on user experience - hotel staff need simple, fast interfaces • Prioritize reliability and uptime - hotels can't afford downtime • Build strong integrations early - channel connectivity is essential • Listen to your customers - hotels know what they need • Price competitively for small properties to gain market entry • Provide excellent support - hospitality is a 24/7 business Good luck building your Hotel Management SaaS!